

STAGE FOURTEEN • PROJECT MANAGEMENT

FIRSTS

Project Management

SESSION 1

Project Planning Foundations

FIRSTS R1-R10

Project Management Awareness

- Five phases: initiate, plan, execute, monitor, close
- Closure is easy to skip — don't
- Foundation for the whole stage

Project Initiation

- Purpose, outcome, why it matters, stakeholders
- Skipping this to save time rarely saves time
- Confirm before real work begins

Project Scope Defined

- In scope AND explicitly out of scope
- Undefined scope invites scope creep
- The boundary you'll protect later

Project Requirements Gathered

- The stated request $\neq$ the real need
- Probe past the first answer
- Technically complete $\neq$ actually useful

Project Deliverables Defined

- Vague deliverables can't be checked off
- Map every requirement to something tangible
- Sets up genuine closure later

Project Timeline Created

- Milestones and dependencies, not just tasks
- A shared, explicit sequence
- Catches conflicts before they happen

Project Work Breakdown

- Too large to assign = too vague to track
- Break it down to genuinely manageable pieces
- The link between planning and real delegation

Project Resource Plan

- Confirm availability, don't assume it
- Gaps discovered mid-project cause real delays
- People, tools, budget, materials

Project Risk Register

- Proactive beats reactive, every time
- A living document, not a kickoff formality
- Every risk needs a real mitigation plan

Project Dependency Map

- What's blocked, waiting on what
- Implicit dependencies get missed
- Closes the planning section

SESSION 2

Managing Execution

FIRSTS R11-R20

Project Stakeholder Map

- Influence and interest, not just involvement
- Missed stakeholders surface late, painfully
- Foundation for real communication

Project Communication Plan

- Tailor frequency and detail to real need
- One-size-fits-all under- and over-informs
- Built directly on the stakeholder map

Project Status Report

- Same format, every time
- Lets stakeholders track real trends
- A recurring habit, not a one-off

Project Milestone Achieved

- The date arriving $\neq$ the criteria being met
- Confirm explicitly, don't assume
- Prevents false progress

Project Change Request

- Formal evaluation, not silent absorption
- Protects the scope from R3
- Document real impact before approving

Project Issue Log

- What's already happened, tracked to resolution
- Scattered messages let issues vanish
- Distinct from the risk register

Project Risk Mitigation

- A plan on paper isn't protection
- Actually execute the mitigation
- Turns R9 from documentation into action

Project Budget Created

- Track real spending, not just an estimate
- Catch overruns while they're still fixable
- Extends the resource plan from R8

Project Schedule Updated

- An outdated schedule is fiction
- Update honestly, even when it's uncomfortable
- Confusion costs more than the admission

Project Management Tool Used

- One system, not five disconnected documents
- Consolidates everything from R1-R19
- Closes the execution section

SESSION 3

Modern Methodologies & Closing Out

FIRSTS R21-R30

Agile Project Experience

- Iterative, not fixed and sequential
- Complements traditional planning, doesn't replace it
- Adapt based on real feedback

Scrum Experience

- Each ceremony has a distinct real purpose
- Not just “more meetings”
- One specific, widely used Agile framework

Kanban Workflow

- Continuous flow for unpredictable work
- Genuinely different from Scrum, not lesser
- Match the method to the actual work

Project Progress Review

- Honest, not optimistic
- Catch small delays before they compound
- Confront reality, don't gloss over it

Project Escalation

- Neither avoided nor vague
- A specific, clear ask
- A normal, responsible action, not a failure

Project Recovery Plan

- Address the root cause, not just push harder
- Pushing harder on a broken plan rarely works
- Genuine diagnostic thinking

Project Handoff

- Context, not just the final deliverable
- Enables real, intelligent maintenance
- Extends the Stage Thirteen handoff practice

Project Closure

- Formal, confirmed, not a quiet fade-out
- Verifies the deliverables from R5
- Loose ends left unaddressed otherwise

Project Lessons Learned

- Specific and actionable, not “communicate better”
- Otherwise relearned the hard way next time
- Write it down, actually use it later

End-to-End Project Managed

- One project, full lifecycle, independently
- Proves the accumulated skill of this stage
- The real capstone, not a single-FIRST checkbox

Stage Fourteen, Complete

One real project, named out loud, you'll manage end-to-end.